

various brands from Germany and the USA in India. It serves as an exclusive partner for these brands to sell their products in India. The company sells DNA kits in neighbouring countries like Sri Lanka and Bangladesh, too. The kits, claims the company, match the international ISO quality standards.

The company has shown positive signs of growth since the last decade. "The demand of our products, especially DNA isolation kits, has increased due to the vested commercial interest of the diagnostic labs. We are now thinking to set up our own manufacturing plant. The machine and equipment investment for the same is around 50 million Indian rupees. We plan to recover our investment within the first four years, keeping in view the pace at which our business is expanding," says Ritesh, founder of Pro Gen Bio Labs.

"The avenues and demand of DNA testing kits are increasing with each passing year. Being an Indian company also gives us the power to leverage opportunities in the Asia Pacific region and the rest of the world," explains Ritesh.

Most of the companies selling DNA testing kits in India are subsidiaries of their western counterparts. They need to embed efficient technology processes at the core of their business strategy.

"With coherent technology enablers like automation and IoT, my business efficiency has increased almost ten-fold," informs Pranav Mishra of Genetic Biotech. "We utilise Syska LED solutions for our enterprise. This has saved us about 40 per cent of our annual power expenses. Our genetic modelling and interpretation is enabled by Amazon's AWS Artificial Intelligence."

The market for DNA testing kits is quite young and very dynamic. It needs greater support, clearer guidelines and better standardisa-

tion from the regulatory authorities.

Abdur, co-founder of XCode India, shares, "DNA testing kits are in demand by clinics, nutritionists, physicians and other healthcare professionals as well. Personalised recommendations in these domains based on genetic know-how is an added advantage. We provide continuous training programmes to our business partners so that they are aware of the latest in genetic science."

The market environment for DNA testing kits is changing at a very fast pace. Those who invest in this business are likely to gain advantage from the initial momentum upsurge. **EFY**

—Nidhi Arora, executive editor, *EFY*



Interesting Ways Smart Plugs Improve Your Business

► **Businesses can save big money by handing over the switching control of their appliances to smart plugs**

The benefits of smart plugs, smart switches and power strips for businesses are aplenty. Capable of saving 20 to 30 per cent of energy consumption by controlling electrical appliances, these devices have become regular favourites in many offices. However, their usefulness expands beyond the realm of energy savings. Commonly found in current ratings between

6A and 16A, smart plugs can be useful in an amazingly large number of applications.

Smart plugs find an interesting use case in the form of billboards and signage control. Parth Bhatt, application engineer, Energy Bots, shared applications of their ePlug: "Brands often find their signage boards turned off. One of our customers is using ePlug to monitor whether the retail stores where they have advertised their board are turning it on in time or not. They are using it to remotely control and automate the lighting schedule of their boards."

Betty, a smart plug made by Beyond Evolution, is also finding similar uses. Enterprises are using it to turn on the billboards during evening and turn these off at dawn.

Cold storage and retail store owners can make great use of smart plugs. Saurabh Sharma, founder of Beyond Evolution, shared that grocery retail store owners use Betty to manage chillers that store their fresh food, milk products and so on. The smart plug allows them to automatically or remotely turn chillers on and off, and track the power consumption data to keep an eye on the performance and energy expenses.

Be it a bank, a jewellery shop or an office, smart plugs and switches can be customised for security notifications and alerts. One such example is SmarteeFi. Bipin Gahlaut, founder, CoreEmbedded Technologies, shared, "A lot of jewellers are purchasing our SmarteeFi smart strip system. They are using it for security purposes alongside automating their lighting appliances."

Sharma explained, "The security sensors we provide with Betty are used by many customers to receive alerts in case there is any unexpected intrusion in their homes while they are away. They are also using the same for their offices on holidays and after work hours."

Smart plug can help to ensure